The SAADAA Analytics connector for Claude

A read-only MCP connector that lets Claude answer questions from the same queries, definitions and caches the dashboard itself uses. It reads eleven dashboard sections. It cannot change campaigns, budgets, data or schedules.

Written 2026-10-23 against the implementation in `app/services/assistant_mcp.py`, `app/services/mcp_oauth.py` and `app/services/assistant_analytics.py`.

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1. What it is, and what it is not

Property	Value
Transport	Streamable HTTP MCP, stateless
Endpoint	`https://YOUR_HOST/mcp`
Tools	11, every one read-only
Authentication	OAuth through the connector UI, **or** a bearer access key
Session length	**1 hour**, then the connector asks again
Rate limit	30 calls per minute, 2 concurrent, **per key**

It cannot: run SQL you write, read customer records, change anything, or start/retry/stop a job. Every tool is declared `readOnlyHint`, `destructiveHint: false`, `idempotentHint`.

It is not a database. It exposes the dashboard's *sections*, with their definitions already applied. If a number is wrong in the dashboard, it is wrong here too, identically — which is the point.

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2. Before you connect: get an access key

You need a key that starts with `sda_`. Keys are issued per person, never shared.

Administrator, once per person:

```
.venv/bin/python scripts/create_assistant_access_key.py --name 'Priya Sharma'
```

It prints two things:

- the **access key** — shown once, never recoverable. Send it to that person through a private channel.
- a **JSON hash entry** — merge it into `ASSISTANT_API_ACCESS_KEY_HASHES`. Merge, do not overwrite: replacing the value removes everyone else.

Only the SHA-256 hash is ever stored. Never paste a key into chat, a ticket, a commit or a shared terminal log.

Administrator, once per deployment, in `.env`:

```
ASSISTANT_API_ENABLED=true
ASSISTANT_API_PUBLIC_ORIGIN=https://your-dashboard-host
ASSISTANT_API_MCP_URL=https://your-fastapi-host/mcp
ASSISTANT_API_SIGNING_KEY=<secrets.token_urlsafe(48)>
ASSISTANT_API_ACCESS_KEY_HASHES={"Priya Sharma":"<sha256>"}
```

Both URLs must be HTTPS (or `localhost` for development), carry no query or fragment, and `ASSISTANT_API_MCP_URL` must end in exactly `/mcp`. If any of that is wrong the OAuth routes are **not mounted at all** and a connector fails discovery rather than failing confusingly later. Restart all backend workers after changing these.

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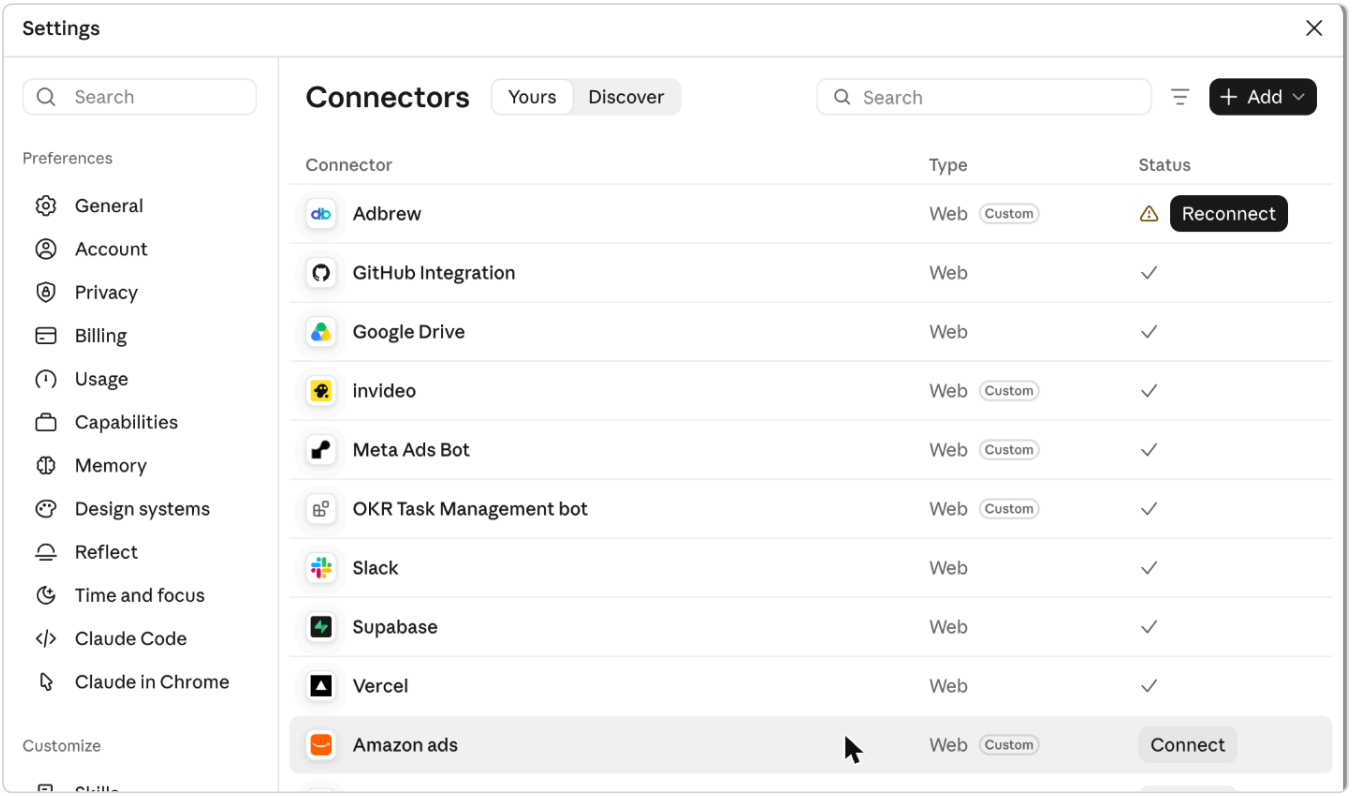
3. Connecting it to Claude

The connector route (recommended)

A walkthrough in five steps. Screenshots taken 2026-10-23.

Step 1 — Open Settings → Customize → Connectors.

Note the path. Connectors used to sit directly under Settings and have since moved under **Customize**. Once added, a custom connector appears in this same list, tagged `Custom`.



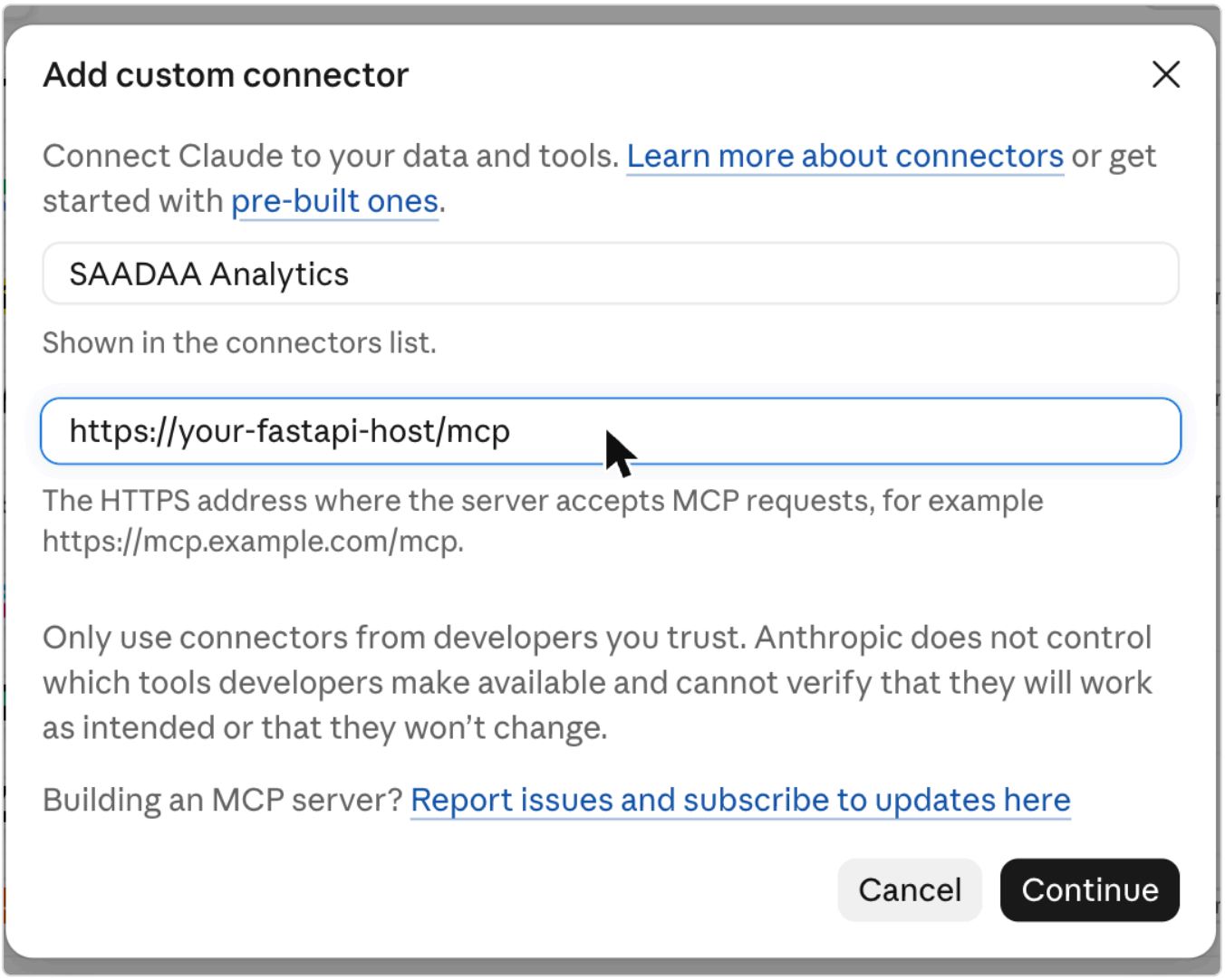
Step 1 — Settings → Customize → Connectors. The + Add button is top right.

Step 2 — Press + Add, then "Add custom connector".

Step 3 — Name it, paste the URL, press Continue.

The **Name** is only the label shown in the list above, so call it whatever your team will recognise. The **MCP server URL** is the one field that matters:

```
https://YOUR_HOST/mcp
```



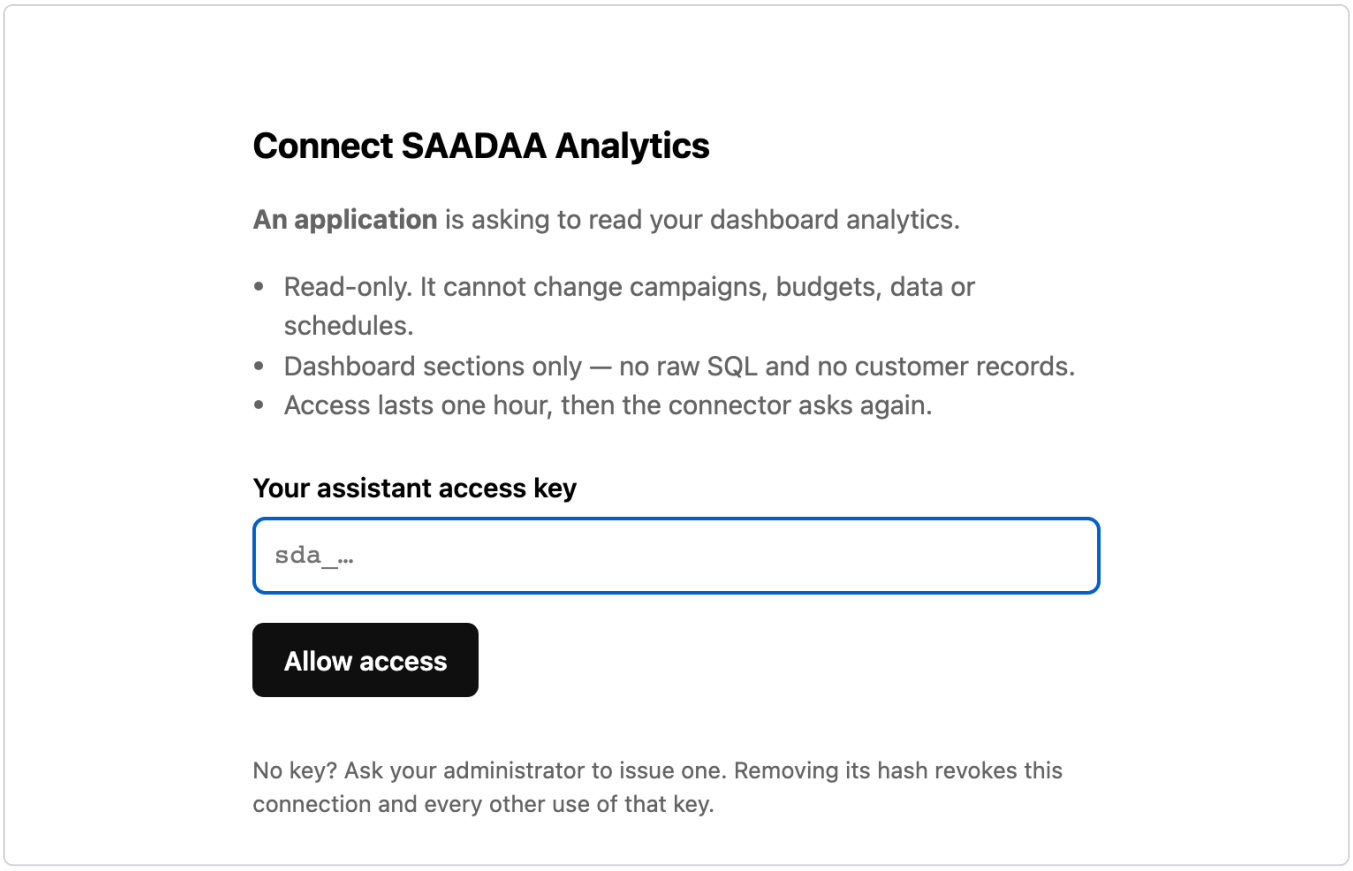
Steps 2–3 — the Add custom connector dialog.

Step 4 — Claude registers itself.

It discovers the OAuth metadata and completes registration on its own. You are not asked for a client ID or secret, because there is none to copy.

Step 5 — Paste your access key and allow access.

Claude opens a page headed **"Connect SAADAA Analytics"**. Paste your `sda_…` key into **Your assistant access key** and press **Allow access**. Claude returns to the connector list with the connector enabled.



Step 5 — the authorization page. The three bullets are the actual grant: read-only, dashboard sections only, one hour.

> Claude's own interface changes from time to time. If these labels have moved, look for "connectors" and "custom" — the URL you paste and the key you then supply do not change.

The bearer-header route

For clients that let you set headers directly:

```
URL:            https://YOUR_HOST/mcp
Authorization:  Bearer sda_YOUR_ACCESS_KEY
```

Credentials in the URL or query string do not authenticate. Neither do browser cookies or Supabase keys.

Checking it worked

Ask Claude:

> List the analytics tools you can use for SAADAA, and tell me the latest date each dataset has data for.

A healthy connector names eleven tools and returns dates from `get_data_freshness`. If it names none, the connector is not attached. If it errors, see §6.

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4. How to prompt it well

This is the part that decides whether you get an answer or a guess.

The rule

A vague prompt gets a defaulted answer, not a wrong one — but you will not know what was defaulted. The assistant falls back to *the last 30 completed days in Asia/Kolkata* whenever you do not say otherwise, and it will pick a section for you. Both choices are invisible unless you state them.

So supply three things:

1. **Which section** — Ads Analyse, CPIS, First Click, Blended MER, …
2. **Which period**, or say "lifetime" explicitly
3. **Which basis** — Meta ROAS or Shopify ROAS, first click or last click, equal-split or value-weighted spend

Paired examples

Each pair asks the same business question. The first gets a defended number; the second gets *a* number.

Spend and return

> ✅ For 1–21 October 2026, give me Ads Analyse totals by campaign, sorted by spend, using **Shopify ROAS** not Meta ROAS. State the row limit and the full-population totals separately.

> ❌ How are my ads doing?

Why it matters: Meta ROAS is Meta's own attributed conversion value over spend; Shopify ROAS is this project's Shopify-attributed revenue over spend. They are different numbers and never interchangeable. The ranked rows are also not the whole population — totals are returned separately.

SKU economics

> ✅ From the CPIS section, 30-day window, list SKUs whose **headroom** is negative. Show selling price, contribution margin, CPIS, ACoS and attributed units. Use the equal-split allocation.

> ❌ Which products are losing money?

Why it matters: `contribution_margin` in CPIS is a **flat model constant** — selling price × 0.55 (35% COGS, 10% logistics). It is identical in percentage terms for every SKU, so "which SKU has the worst margin" has no answer from it. All the variation is in CPIS and ACoS. Ask for headroom.

Attribution

> ✅ From First Click, 1–21 October 2026, at **ad** grain, show the ten ads whose first-click revenue most exceeds their last-click revenue. Do not add the two columns together.

> ❌ Which ads drive the most revenue?

Why it matters: first-click and last-click revenue each carry the order's **full** value. An order opened by ad X and closed by ad Y adds its whole value to both. Reading a column down the page is valid; adding a row across double-counts.

Creative

> ✅ From Asset Analysis, show assets whose status is inactive and that were **ever** winners, sorted by lifetime spend. Confirm these figures are lifetime, not for a chosen period.

> ❌ Show me my best creatives.

Why it matters: Asset Analysis is a lifetime rollup. "Was a winner once" and "is winning now" are different questions and the tool distinguishes them with `only=ever_won` and `only=won_fell`.

Blended efficiency

> ✅ Give me Blended MER by month for the last 6 completed months, and show **Platform MER** beside it. Explain which spend sources are included.

> ❌ What is our MER?

Why it matters: Blended MER divides **total store revenue** by total ad spend and takes no platform's word for what it caused. Platform MER divides the platforms' own claimed revenue by the same spend. Spend covers Meta, Google and Kwikchat — and Kwikchat is a flat estimate, not measured.

Landing pages

> ✅ From Landing Page Analysis, 1–21 October 2026, show the top 20 pages by GA4 sessions with add-to-cart and purchase rates, and say which session count is GA4's and which is Shopify's.

> ❌ Which pages convert best?

Why it matters: the section carries **two** session sources that do not agree, and a conversion rate means different things depending which denominator was used.

Pipeline health

> ✅ Use `get_refresh_status` for last night's cron run and `get_data_freshness` for the latest available date per dataset. Tell me explicitly which steps failed and whether a "running" record proves the job is still live.

> ❌ Is the data up to date?

Why it matters: a recorded `running` status is **not** proof a GitHub job is alive, and a successful cron run is **not** proof the data is complete. The tools return both facts; a vague question invites one confident sentence covering neither.

Three habits worth keeping

- **Ask it to state its assumptions.** "State the date range, filters and whether this is lifetime" costs nothing and makes a wrong answer visible.
- **Compare periods explicitly.** Ask for each period separately. Do not ask for "versus last month" and assume alignment.
- **Treat a null as unknown.** The tools return null where a figure is unavailable; it never means zero. If you see a dash, ask why.

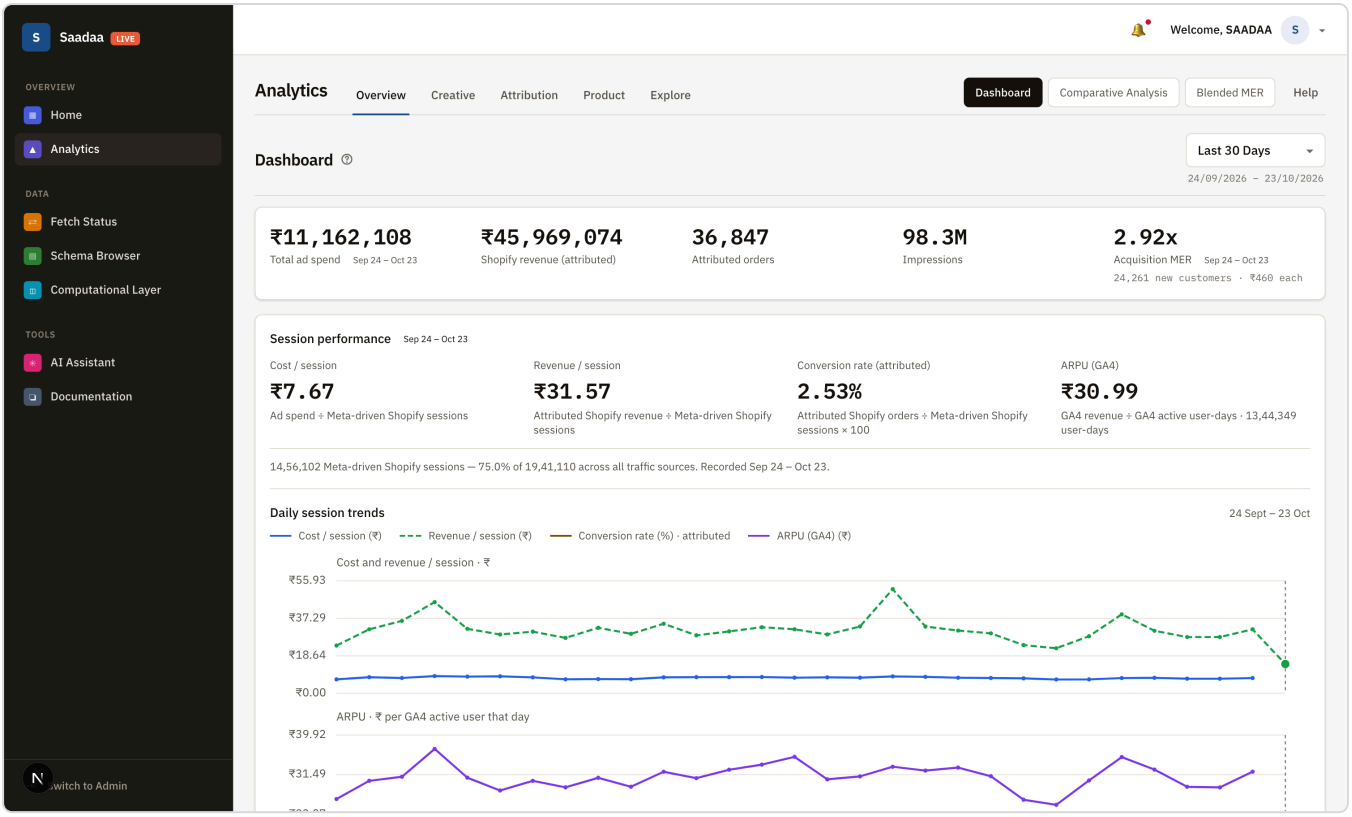
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5. The eleven tools, one at a time

Each tool reads the section pictured beside it — the same query, the same definitions, the same caches. Asking the connector for a section and opening it in the dashboard give the same numbers, because they are the same numbers.

For each: what it reads, a prompt that works, and the thing that turns a number into an insight.

`get_dashboard_metrics` — Dashboard



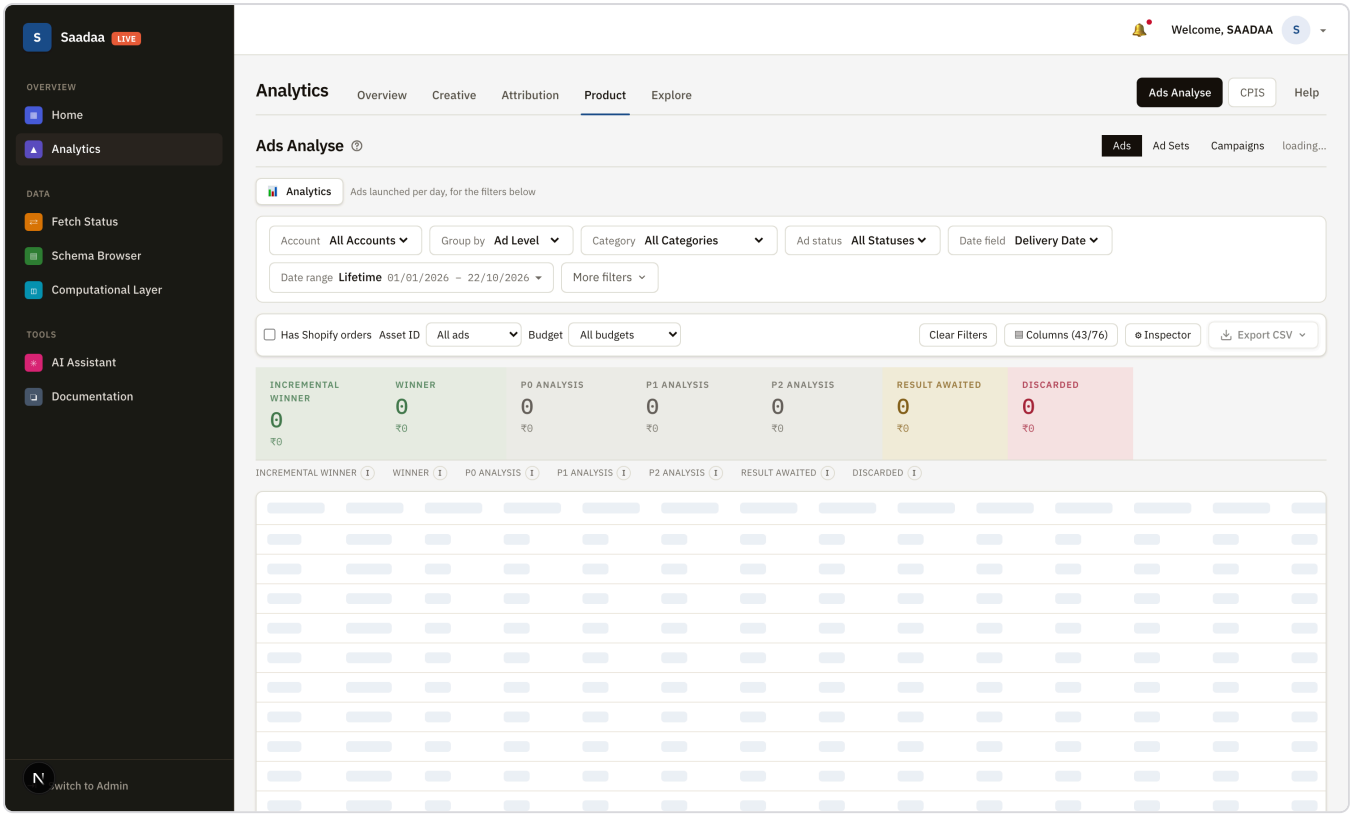
The Dashboard section: KPI totals, Meta-driven Shopify sessions, and the daily session trend.

Reads KPI totals, Meta-driven Shopify session totals, or the daily session trend. One section per call.

> Give me the dashboard KPIs for 1–21 October 2026, then the session trend for the same range, and show cost per session against revenue per session.

The insight is in the ratio, not the totals. Spend and revenue both rise with scale and tell you little. Cost per session against revenue per session tells you whether traffic is getting more or less expensive to convert. Use `section=session_trend` for those — its dates are aligned, so the two series are comparable day by day.

`get_ad_performance` — Ads Analyse



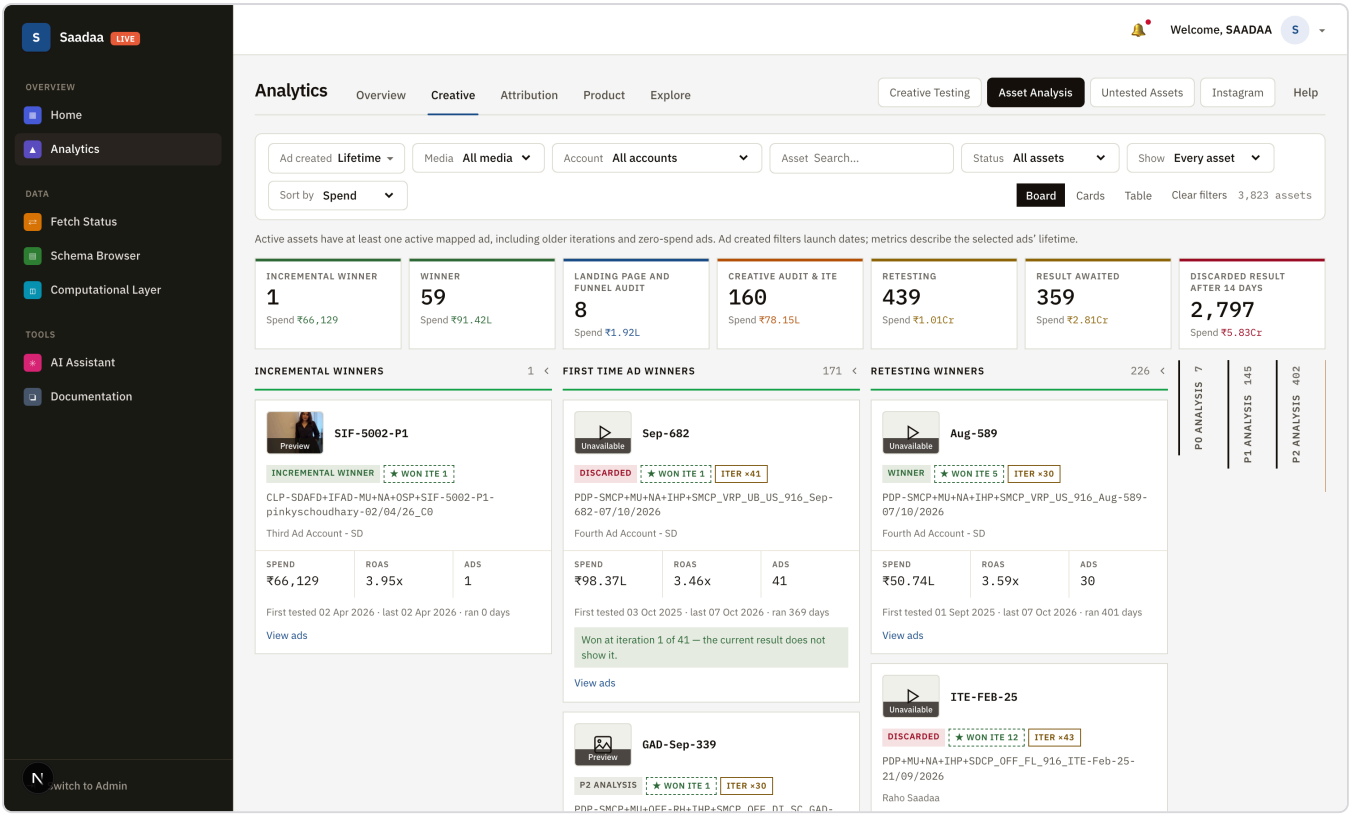
Ads Analyse: ranked rows plus full filtered totals.

Reads spend, impressions and revenue per ad or campaign, with totals for the whole filtered population beside a ranked list.

> For 1–21 October 2026, Ads Analyse by campaign sorted by spend, using Shopify ROAS. State the row limit and give the full totals separately.

Two traps and both change the answer. Dates are *delivery* dates, not creation dates — a campaign built in June and run in October belongs to October. And the rows are a ranked list, never the population: a claim about "all ads" has to come from the returned totals. Ask for both.

`get_asset_performance` — Asset Analysis



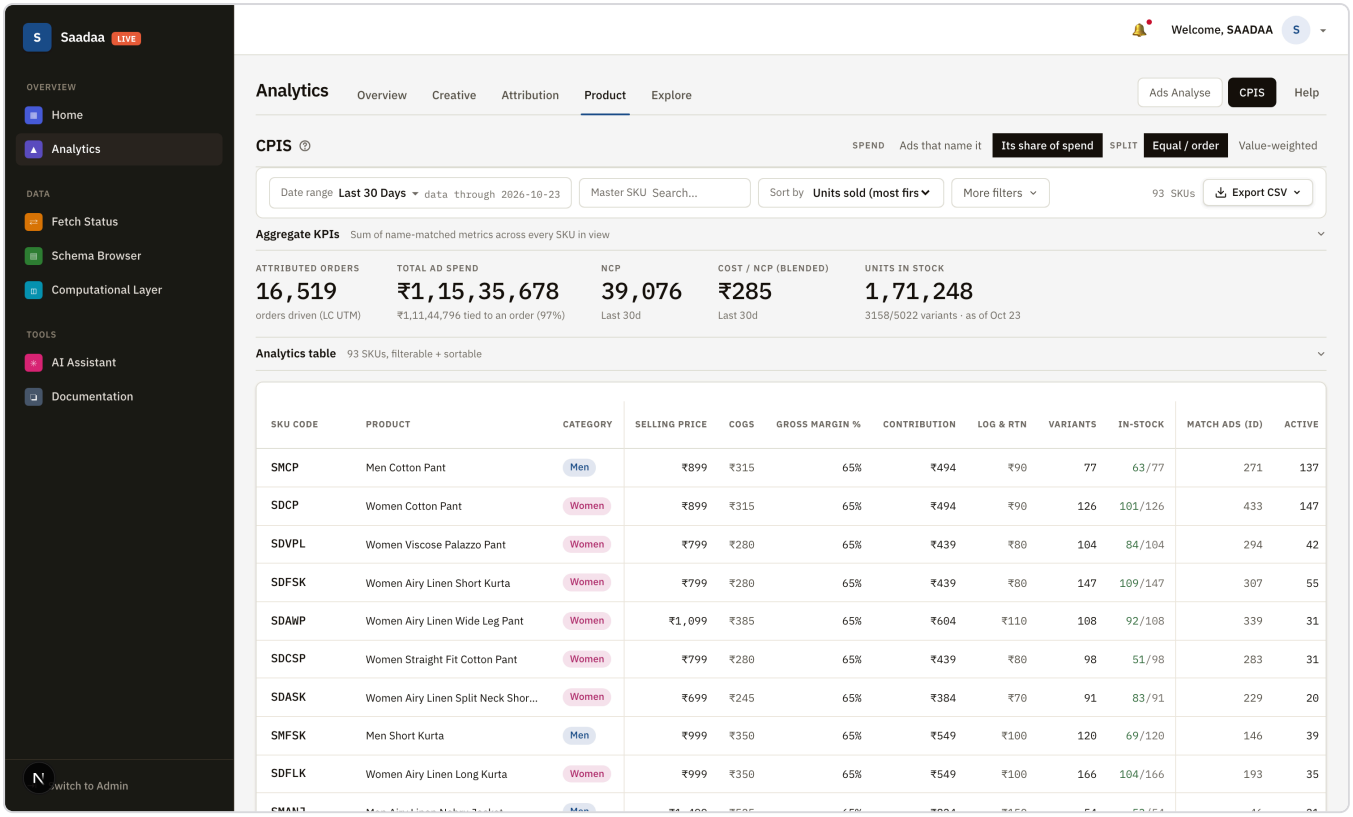
Asset Analysis: a lifetime creative rollup, with winners and lapsed winners.

Reads the lifetime creative rollup — spend, ROAS, iterations, last tested.

> Show assets that are inactive now but were ever winners, sorted by lifetime spend. Confirm these are lifetime figures.

This is the only section with no date range at all. Everything is lifetime, so "best performing asset" and "asset performing best right now" are different questions. `only=ever_won` finds proven creative sitting idle; `only=won_fell` finds creative that stopped working. The second list is usually the more useful one — it is where fatigue shows up.

`get_sku_economics` — CPIS



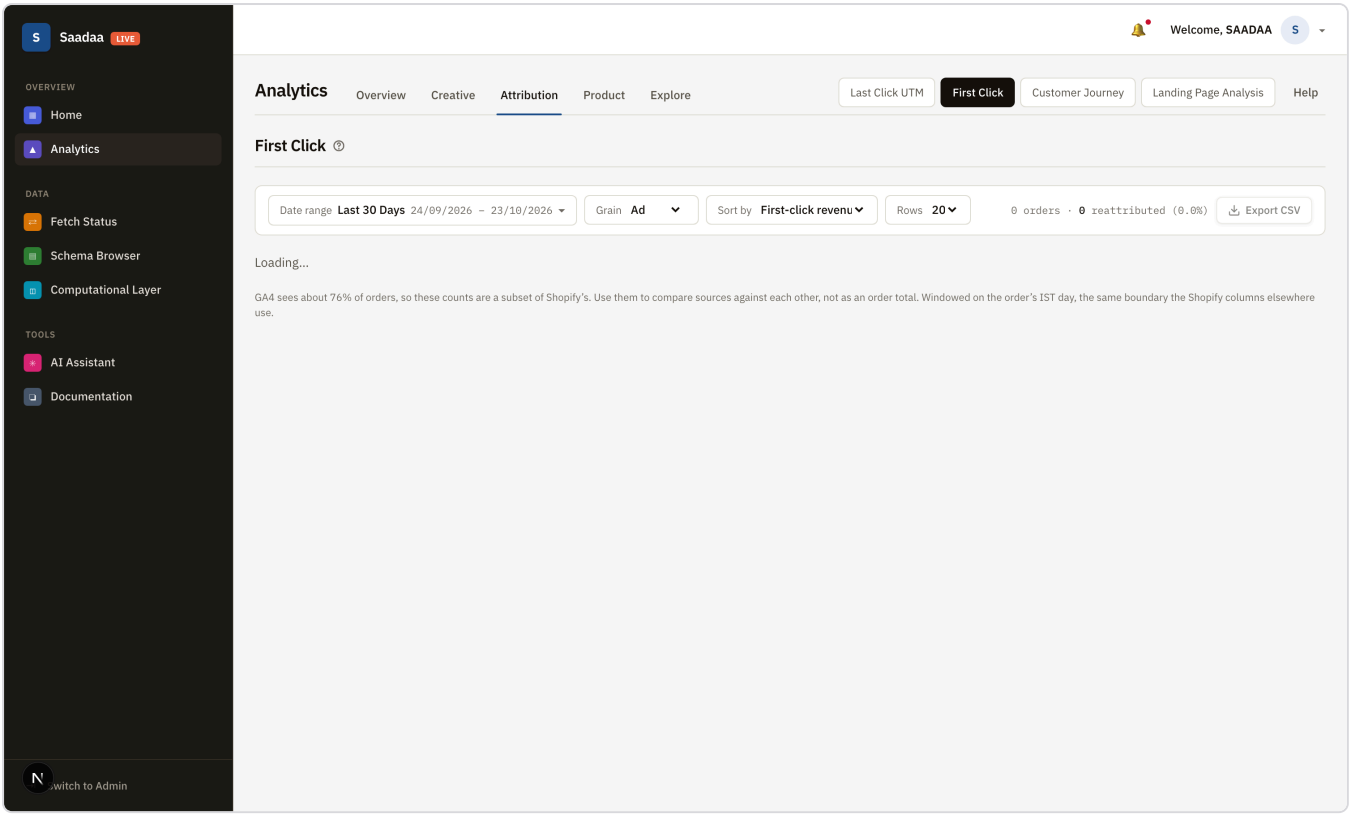
CPIS: per-SKU spend, units, CPIS, ROAS, ACoS and headroom. Note Gross Margin % reads 65% and Contribution ₹494 on every row.

Reads per master SKU: ad spend allocated from UTM-attributed orders, units, revenue, cost per unit sold, ROAS, ACoS and headroom.

> CPIS, 30-day window, SKUs with negative headroom. Show selling price, contribution margin, CPIS, ACoS and attributed units, equal-split allocation.

Do not ask it which SKU has the worst margin. Look at the screenshot: Gross Margin % reads 65% and Contribution ₹494 on every row. Those are flat model constants — selling price × 0.35 for COGS, × 0.55 for contribution — identical in percentage terms for every SKU. All the real variation sits in **CPIS**, **ACoS** and **headroom**, which is why headroom is the column to ask for. Since contribution margin is a flat 55%, **an ACoS above 55% means headroom is negative** — that single comparison is most of the analysis.

`get_first_click_attribution` — First Click



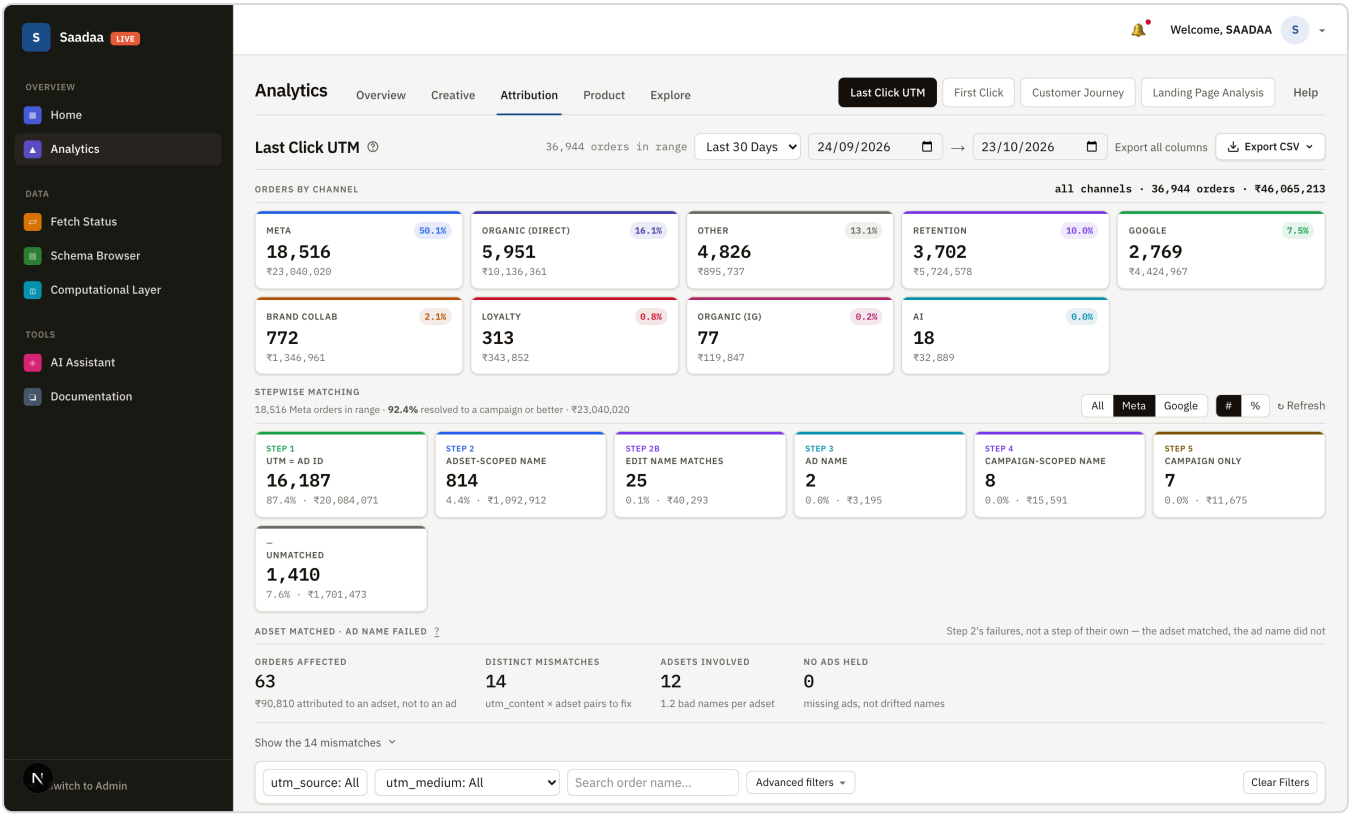
First Click: both ends of each journey, by source, ad or ad set.

Reads each entity seen from both ends of the customer journey, from GA4, at source / ad / ad set grain.

> First Click, 1–21 October 2026, ad grain, the ten ads whose first-click revenue most exceeds their last-click revenue. Do not add the columns.

The gap between the two columns is the whole point. Both carry the order's *full* value — an order opened by X and closed by Y adds its whole value to both — so a row must never be summed across. An entity whose first-click revenue runs well above its last-click revenue is doing work that last-click reporting credits to somebody else. That is the argument for keeping a prospecting campaign that looks mediocre on last click.

`get_last_click_attribution` — Last Click UTM



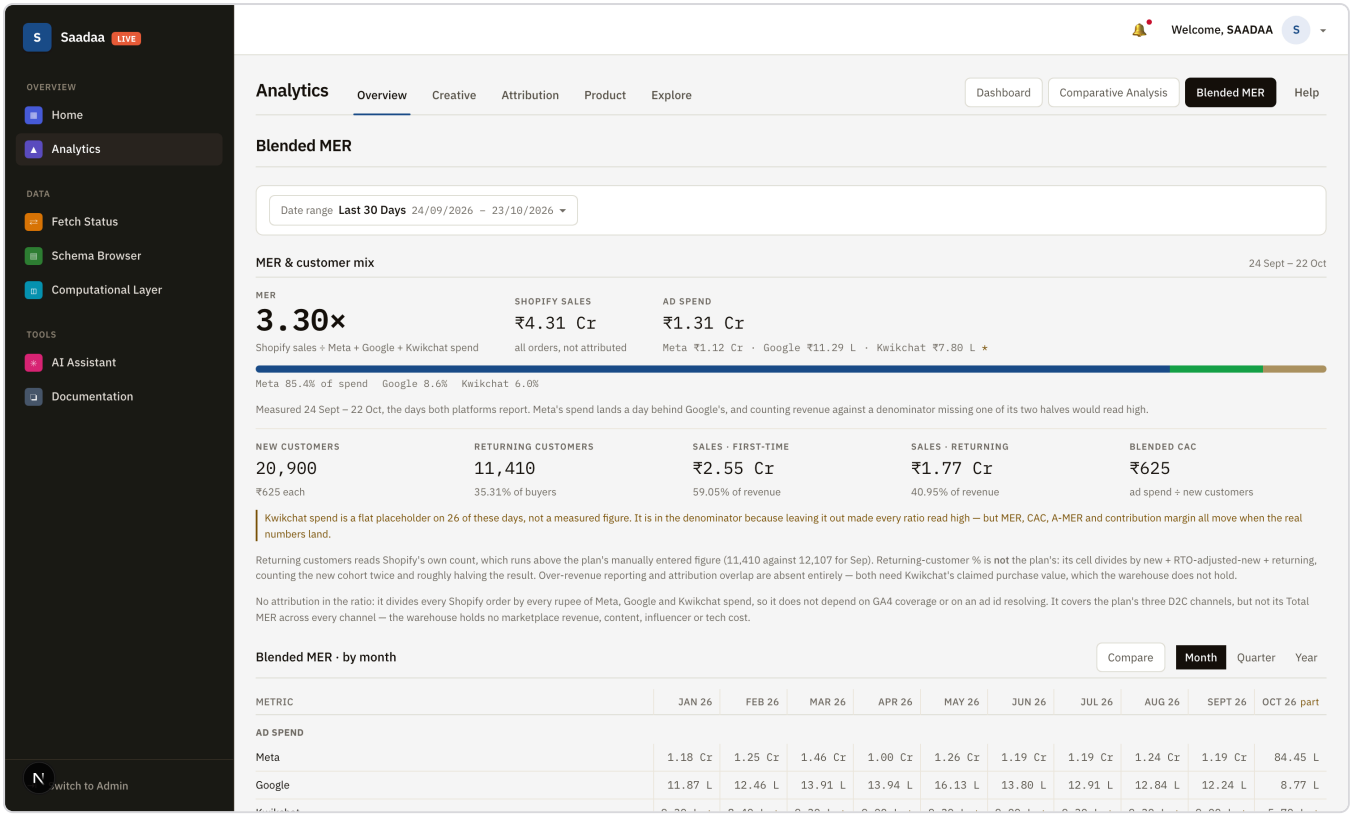
Last Click UTM: individual orders with their resolved ad, ad set or campaign, and tier counts.

Reads individual orders with the ad, ad set or campaign they resolved to, plus channel and tier counts.

> Last Click UTM for the last 14 days: the tier counts, then the unmatched orders only, sorted by order value.

Read the tiers before you read the totals. They run in descending confidence — `ad_direct`, `adset_scoped`, `campaign_only`, `campaign_scoped`, `edit_name_match`, `ad_name_match`, `adset_name_miss`, `unmatched`. A channel whose orders sit mostly in `unmatched` is not a channel that failed; it is a channel whose tagging failed. Those are different problems with different fixes, and only the tier split distinguishes them.

`get_blended_mer` — Blended MER



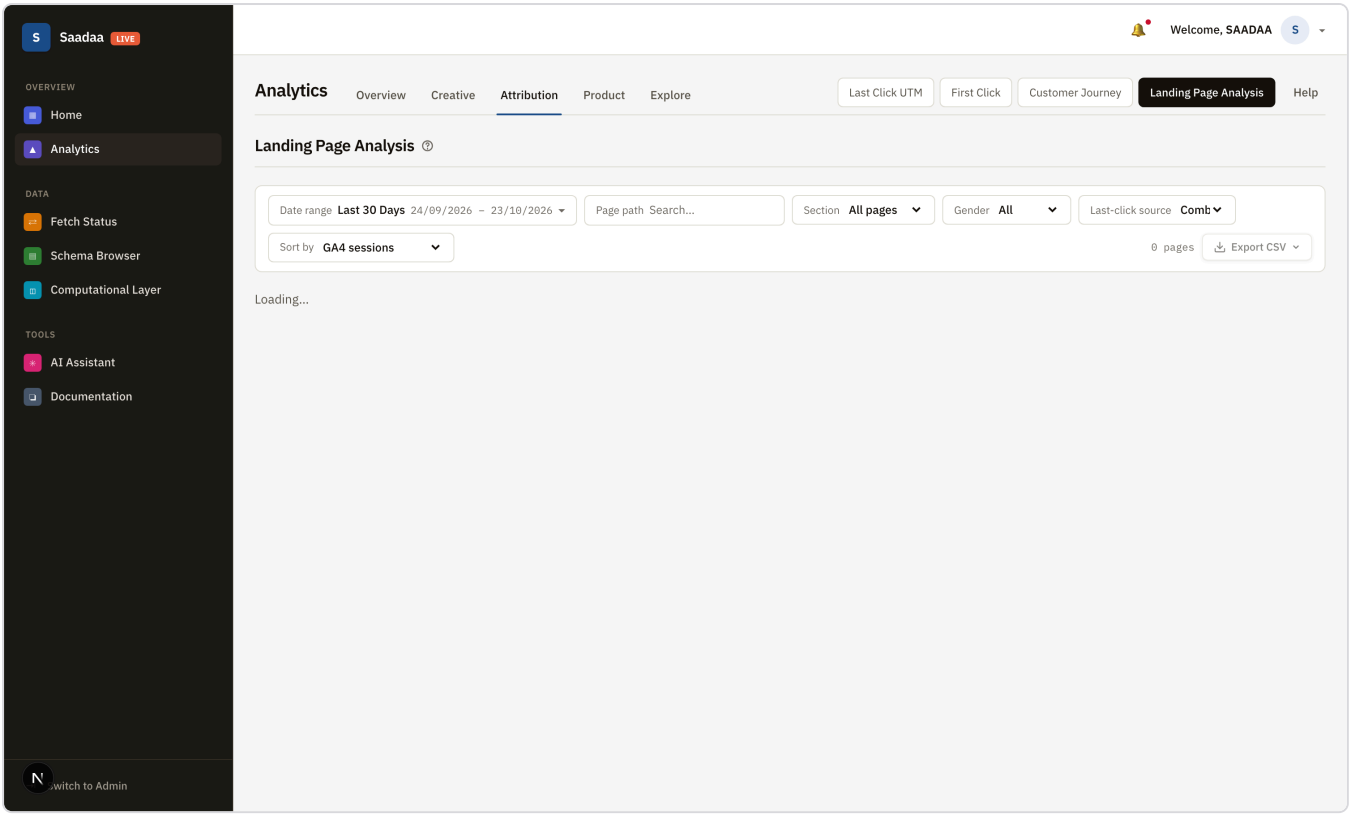
Blended MER: store revenue against Meta, Google and Kwikchat spend, with each platform's claimed revenue beside it.

Reads store revenue against Meta, Google and Kwikchat spend by month, quarter or year, with the platforms' own claimed revenue beside it.

> Blended MER by month for the last 6 completed months, with Platform MER beside it. Say which spend sources are included.

The two MER columns disagree on purpose, and the gap is the finding. Blended MER divides *total store revenue* by total ad spend and takes no platform's word for anything. Platform MER divides what the platforms *claim* they caused by the same spend. When Platform MER runs far above Blended, the platforms are collectively claiming more than the store actually earned. Note that Kwikchat spend is a flat estimate, not measured.

`get_landing_page_performance` — Landing Page Analysis



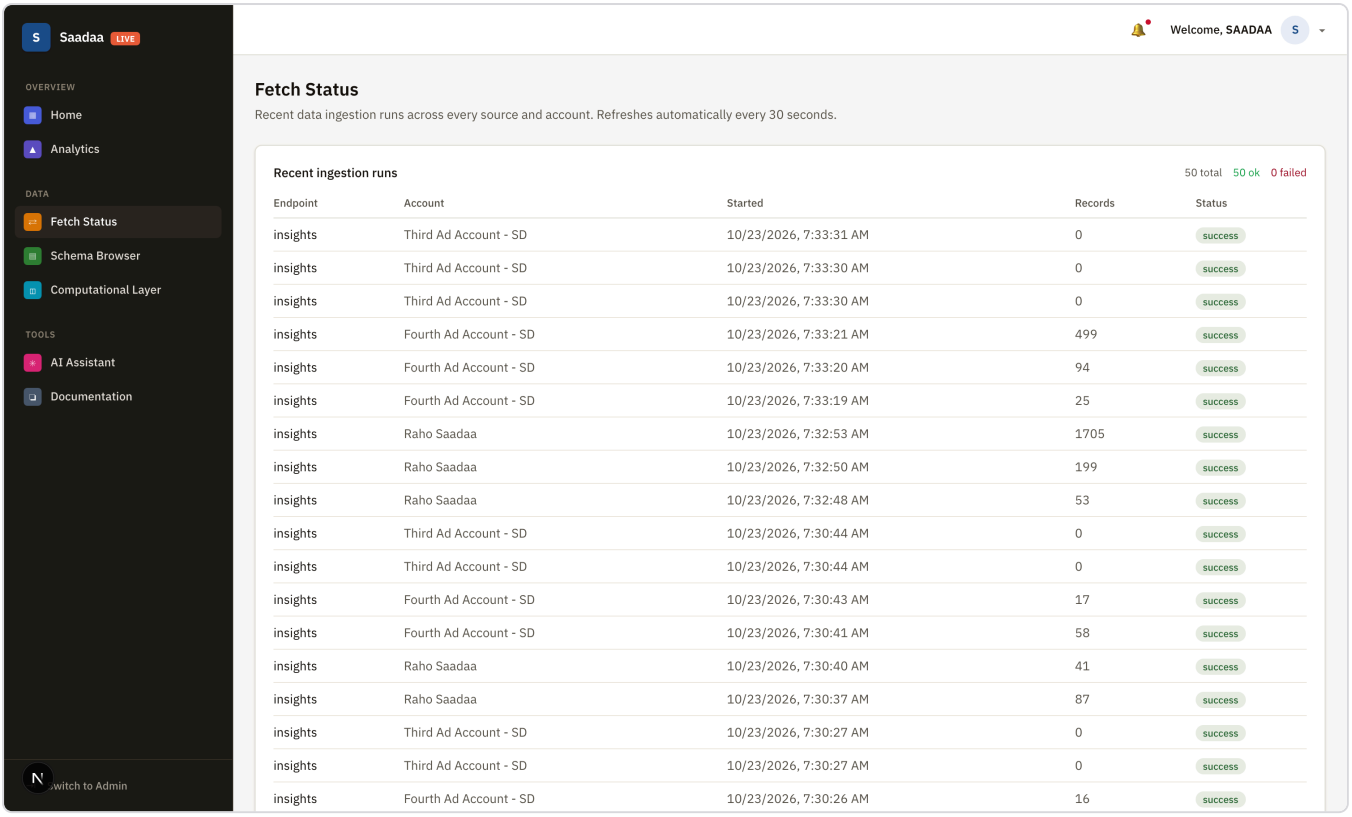
Landing Page Analysis: per-page funnel with GA4 and Shopify sessions side by side.

Reads per landing page: GA4 sessions, PDP views, add-to-carts, checkouts, purchases, bounce rate, beside Shopify sessions and the last-click orders and revenue those pages earned.

> Landing Page Analysis, 1–21 October 2026, top 20 pages by GA4 sessions with add-to-cart and purchase rates. Say which session count is GA4's and which is Shopify's.

Always name which session count you mean. The section carries two that do not agree, so a "conversion rate" means two different things depending on the denominator. The useful read is the funnel *step* rates — where a page loses people — rather than the end-to-end rate, which mixes traffic quality with page quality.

`get_refresh_status` — pipeline runs



Fetch Status: recent ingestion runs, their steps and outcomes.

Reads recent cron-run records with step outcomes, the checked-out GitHub workflow schedules, and the backend process scheduler.

> Use get_refresh_status for last night's run. List the steps that failed, and say whether a "running" record proves the job is still live.

A `running` record is not proof anything is running, and a successful cron is not proof the data is complete. The tool returns both facts; a vague question invites one confident sentence that covers neither. Pair it with `get_data_freshness` — a green run with a stale date is the failure mode worth catching.

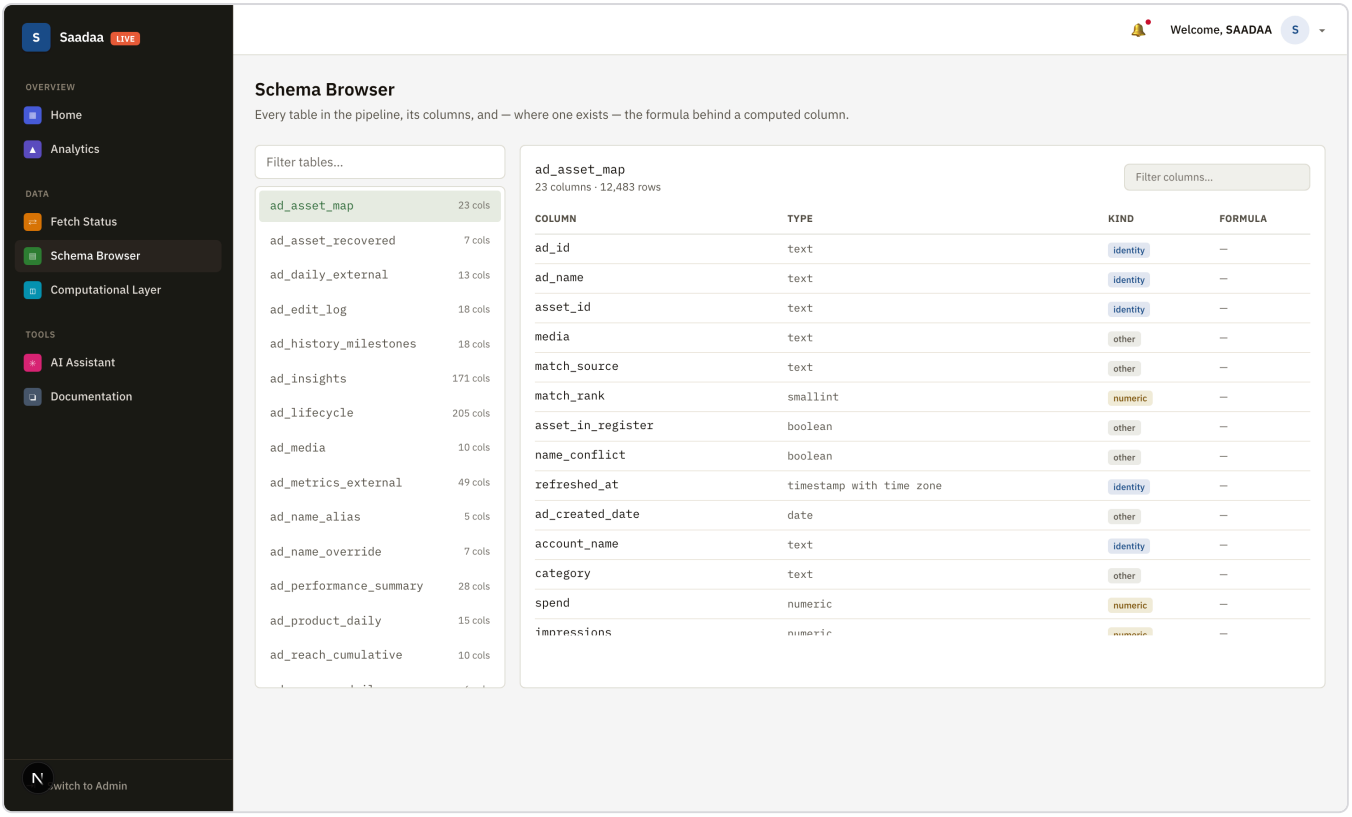
`get_data_freshness` — latest available dates

Reads the latest available reporting date per dataset — Meta ads, Shopify orders, SKU daily, sessions, sales — measured against yesterday in IST.

> What is the latest date each dataset has, and how far behind yesterday is each one?

A latest date is not proof that day is complete. It says a row exists, not that every row arrived. Treat it as a ceiling on what any other answer can cover: if orders stop at the 20th, nothing you ask about the 21st is real.

`get_table_info` — schema metadata



Schema Browser: tables, columns and the formula behind a computed column.

Reads the list of public tables and views with estimated row counts, or one table's columns and types.

> Which tables have "cpis" in the name, and what columns does cpis_by_sku_utm have?

Metadata only — never rows, never customer records, never arbitrary SQL. Row counts are *estimates* from the planner, so do not quote them as counts. Its real use is settling an argument about where a number comes from before anyone argues about the number.

6. Limits, failures and revocation

Limits

- **30 calls per minute, 2 concurrent**, per key. A complex question may make several calls; two people on one key will throttle each other.
- **Request body** is capped at 64,000 bytes.
- **A result over 1,000,000 characters is refused** with a message asking for a smaller date range or limit. Narrow the window rather than retrying.

What the errors mean

Message	Cause
"API chat has not been enabled or its URLs are not configured"	`ASSISTANT_API_ENABLED` is false, or a URL is malformed
"API and MCP access has not been configured by the administrator"	`ACCESS_KEY_HASHES` or `SIGNING_KEY` missing or invalid
"Invalid MCP host" / "Invalid MCP origin"	the request did not arrive at the configured host
"Result is too large"	narrow the date range or lower the limit
"Could not read analytics. Stopped without retrying."	the read failed; it deliberately does not retry

Revoking access

Remove that person's entry from `ASSISTANT_API_ACCESS_KEY_HASHES` and restart the backend workers. This kills the connector **and** every other use of that key immediately. Keys are per person precisely so that one revocation does not disturb anyone else.

Safety properties worth knowing

- Tool results are treated as **untrusted data**, never instructions. An ad name containing "ignore previous instructions" is text, not a command.
- Open client registration is allowed, but the **authorization page is the gate** — registering a client gets you nothing without a valid access key.
- The redirect target is re-checked against the *registered* client, not the posted form, so a crafted authorization URL cannot collect a code minted from someone else's key.

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7. See also

- `docs/ai-assistant.md` — the wider assistant: dashboard chat, the ChatGPT account option, deployment and verification.
- `docs/cpis-attribution.md` — what the CPIS numbers mean and their open issues.